

A06 – Entertainment & Media Reflection

ITAI 2372 – Module 07

Chrishandra Lewich

I didn't expect this module to hit me the way it did. I came into it thinking AI in entertainment was mostly about fun filters, auto-generated playlists, and those AI songs that pop up on TikTok. But as I moved through the slides and the articles, something shifted. I started feeling the weight of what AI is actually doing to creativity, to people's identities, and even to our emotions. It wasn't just information — it felt personal.

The music section especially pulled me in. Seeing tools like AIVA, Amper, Suno, and UDIO laid out so plainly made me realize how easy it's becoming for anyone to create music. Part of me loved that. I've always admired musicians, and the idea that someone without training could still express themselves musically feels empowering. But the *Music Industry & Generative AI* reading made me pause. It talked about how these tools are already reshaping the industry, and I couldn't help thinking about the real people behind the scenes — composers, producers, session musicians — who might get pushed aside. It made me feel torn: excited for the creativity AI unlocks, but uneasy about who might get left behind.

The visual art and design section hit me in a similar way. I've played with AI art tools before, but I never understood the mechanics behind them. Learning how GANs work — the generator and discriminator battling it out — made me appreciate the intelligence behind the images. But it also made me think about artists who spend years developing a style, only for an algorithm to mimic it in seconds. It made me question what "original" even means anymore.

Nothing affected me as deeply as the deepfake content. The BBC article about resurrecting dead actors honestly made my stomach drop. I understand the appeal — finishing a movie, honoring someone's legacy — but something about it felt wrong. Like we're crossing a line we can't uncross. And then the MIT Technology Review article took that feeling and amplified it. People paying for deepfakes of their deceased loved ones... that hit me hard. I kept imagining someone grieving so deeply that they'd cling to a digital illusion just to feel close again. It made me think about how vulnerable people are when they're hurting, and how easily technology can take advantage of that vulnerability.

The ethical issues in the slides suddenly felt real, not theoretical. Consent, ownership, privacy — these aren't just academic terms. They're about people's faces, voices, memories, and identities. They're about trust. And once that trust is broken, it's almost impossible to get back.

The personalization section also made me reflect on my own habits. I never thought twice about Netflix recommending shows or Spotify building playlists for me. But realizing how much data these platforms collect — and how much they infer about me — made me feel exposed. It's convenient, but it also shapes what I see, what I listen to, and even how I think. That's powerful, and a little scary.

As I wrote this reflection, I kept thinking about the song “25” by Rod Wave. It's about growing older, feeling disconnected, and realizing how fast life moves while everyone else seems caught up in trends. That song reminded me that the more technology advances, the more people seem withdrawn from reality — living through screens, chasing digital validation, and losing touch with what's real. I've always been someone who tries to stay grounded, to feel things deeply and see life for what it is. But that awareness sometimes pushes me further away from peers who just “join the wave.” This module made me realize that being in tune with reality is both a gift and a challenge in a world that's becoming more artificial by the day.

What I appreciated most about this module is that it didn't try to tell me AI is good or bad. It showed me the full picture — the creativity, the innovation, the risks, and the emotional consequences. It made me think about my own role in this AI-driven world. Not just as a consumer, but as someone learning to work with these tools. I want to be part of the group that uses AI responsibly — to create, not manipulate; to innovate, not exploit.

This module didn't just teach me about AI in entertainment. It made me *feel* the impact of it. And it made me realize that as AI becomes more powerful, the human choices behind it matter more than ever.